✦ DEBATE PREP PACKAGE

Should the U.S. recognize Somaliland as a sovereign nation?

Everything you need to understand the topic from scratch and argue **both** sides: the background, the history, the neighbors, the strongest arguments, evidence cards, and cross-examination practice.

The topic in 30 seconds

Somaliland is the northern strip of Somalia, along the Gulf of Aden. It has governed itself since **1991**, with its own government, army, money, passports and elections. On paper, though, almost every country still treats it as part of **Somalia**.

Israel became the first country to recognize it, in **December 2025**. The **United States has not**. A State Department report to Congress in 2026 said the U.S. still considers Somaliland part of Somalia.

The debate comes down to two things the U.S. cares about: **rewarding a peaceful democracy** (Aff) versus **keeping borders stable and partners happy** (Neg).

✧ Start here

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1. Topic Basics

Where it is, what "recognition" means, key words.

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2. History

From British colony to 30+ years of self-rule.

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3. Neighbors & Map

Who's nearby, who wants what, and the map.

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4. Affirmative

Reasons to recognize, plus the attacks to expect.

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5. Negative

Reasons not to, plus the attacks to expect.

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6. Evidence Cards

Your Aff and Neg cards, and how to cut cards.

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7. Cross-Ex Practice

Tough questions with model answers.

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8. Debate Skills

Claim → proof → so what, and mistakes to avoid.

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9. Sources

Every link, plus what still needs checking.

✧ Current status (as of October 2026)

Question	Answer
Has the U.S. recognized Somaliland?	**No.** It follows a "One Somalia" policy, which the State Department reaffirmed in a 2026 report to Congress.
Has anyone recognized it?	**Israel**, on December 26, 2025. No other country has followed.
Is the U.S. talking to Somaliland?	**Yes, unofficially.** U.S. officials have visited, and Somaliland's president met Senator Ted Cruz in Washington in September 2026.
Who supports recognition in Congress?	Mostly some Republicans, including Sen. Ted Cruz. A bill, H.R. 3992, calls for recognition.

⚠ **WATCH OUT FOR FAKES**

In January 2026 a **fake press release** claiming the U.S. had recognized Somaliland spread online. The U.S. Embassy in Mogadishu called it false. Always check claims about recognition against a reliable source.

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💡 **HOW TO USE THIS SITE**

Read the pages in order the first time. Before a round, review Affirmative, Negative and Cross-Ex. Items marked VERIFY still need a source checked before you quote them. And always explain arguments **in your own words**.